Use ChatGPT to Get Clear About the Help Mom Needs Right Now

Four prompts to sort out what you've seen, who's already helping, what you still don't know, and the questions to bring to a professional.

Where you are

Mom came home from the hospital and “needs more help.” Nobody has said what that means, and you're filling the gaps from the diagnosis.

This guide gives you four ChatGPT prompts to organize what you already know and to see what you don't know yet. It is preparation, not an assessment. Use only information you have permission to share, with names removed. The AI organizes and drafts; it does not diagnose, assess safety, or decide. Bring clinical questions to a clinician, and call emergency services for an emergency.

What you'll have at the end

You can describe what she can do, where she already gets help, and the questions a professional still has to answer.

A one-page list: What we know, What we don't know, Questions we need answered, and who to ask.

Before you start

- Your own notes about a typical day, however rough.
- Who helps Mom, and roughly when.
- Discharge papers or a medication list, if you have them. You don't need everything.

PROMPT 1

Start with what you've actually seen

WHY THIS MATTERS

It's easy to think about the diagnosis instead of what happens at breakfast, in the bathroom, or getting to the car. The diagnosis is important, but it doesn't tell you what Mom did this morning.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

A few lines about a typical day, in your own words. Don't tidy them up.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is what I've actually seen my mother do and not do over the last week or two:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Using only what I've written, sort it into four lists: DOES ON HER OWN, NEEDS SOME HELP, NEEDS

> REMINDERS OR SUPERVISION, and I HAVEN'T OBSERVED THIS. Do not use her diagnosis to fill in anything I didn't say. Then give me five things to watch for over the next few days.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A picture built from your observations, not from the diagnosis, with the empty spots labeled.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Watch for the five things over the next few days and add what you see to your notes.

PROMPT 2

Count the help that's already happening

WHY THIS MATTERS

Families underestimate the care they already provide. One person handles pills, someone brings groceries, a neighbor checks in. Mom may be "independent" because five people quietly make it so.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

A list of everyone who helps, what they do, and roughly when.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is everyone who helps my mother and what I know about what they do:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Make a simple table: who helps, what they help with, how often, and when. Then list the times of day and the activities where I haven't named anyone. Treat an uncovered time as something to look into, not as proof she is unsafe.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Help you weren't counting, and the hours nobody has mentioned.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Ask the people on the list whether the table matches what they actually do.

PROMPT 3

Find out what you don't know yet

WHY THIS MATTERS

The most useful thing the AI can do here is not answer questions. It's to show you the questions you haven't asked.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The results of the first two prompts.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is what I've organized so far about my mother's situation:
>
> [PASTE THE RESULTS OF PROMPTS 1 AND 2]
>
> Based only on this, which parts of daily life haven't I said anything about? Think about bathing, dressing, eating, toileting, moving around, memory, mood, medications, meals, and recent changes. List the gaps as questions I could try to answer by observing or asking. Don't answer them yourself.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A short list of gaps you can close with a phone call or a day of watching.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Pick the two gaps that worry you most and close them this week.

PROMPT 4

Sort your questions by who can answer them

WHY THIS MATTERS

Some questions you can answer by paying attention. Others need a nurse, a doctor, a pharmacist, or a care consultant. Knowing which is which is the whole point of this guide.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Everything from the first three prompts.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is everything I've gathered about my mother's care needs:
>
> [PASTE EVERYTHING FROM PROMPTS 1 TO 3]

> Give me one page with three headings: WHAT WE KNOW, WHAT WE DON'T KNOW, and QUESTIONS WE NEED ANSWERED. Under the last heading, mark each question with who should answer it: family, a care consultant, a doctor or nurse, a pharmacist, or not sure. Do not answer the medical questions or suggest changes to any medication.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

One page you could hand to someone and have them understand where things stand.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Keep the page. It's the start of the next step below.

Ready for the next step?

You've organized what you know. The care interview walks you through Mom's situation area by area so nothing important is overlooked, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to a professional.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›

From the Family Care Roadmap · Richard Ladson, Certified Medicaid Planner. Draft of the new prompt-guide shape, written 2026-10-02 for review; the other briefs still carry the original prompt guide.